



Oldest known animal

Evidence suggests a 558 year fossil of Dickinsonia is the oldest known animal on the planet.
<https://digit.in/oct18-70-1>



4D Printing Ink

Researchers develop a cost effective cellulose based 4D printing ink which responds to water.
<https://digit.in/oct18-70-2>



THE OCEAN CLEANUP

The System 001 - a 600 meter long floater that captures plastic waste in the oceans, is on its way to tackle the great Pacific Garbage Patch.

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The Ocean Cleanup is a non-profit organisation funded in 2013 by the then 18 year old Boyan Slat. The purpose of the company is to tackle the plastic waste in the oceans. On 9 September, 2018, the organisation launched one of the most ambitious

attempts to cleanup the great Pacific garbage patch.

The patch is a giant vortex of garbage that spans the largest ocean on the planet, from the west coast of North America to the east coast of Japan. The floating litter accumulates there because of a system of cyclic ocean currents - or gyres. The plastic litter can stay in the oceans practically forever. In the gyres, the plastic does break up into smaller and smaller pieces though. Millimeter sized pieces

of plastic gets consumed by the marine life forms. These toxic plastic particles make their way up the food chain, and even ends up in seafood restaurants around the world - which are then consumed by humans. Conventional approaches of cleaning the patch involves using fleets of vessels tugging nets in their wakes to capture the garbage. Such an effort would take thousands of years, and would cost billions of dollars.

THE 600 METER LONG FLOATER

The solution? The System 001. It is a 600 meter long floater, with a skirt underneath it for the entire length. The skirt tapers over its three meter length. The floater follows the currents